

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's Reflections on: **PRAYER, PROCLAMATION and PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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A series of reflections from the Song of Solomon and the love relationship between two betrothed persons – a Bridegroom and a Bride to be - [Series Two]

Looking at some of the spiritual truths that we might glean from their love journey together.

Our passage: *Song of Solomon 5:5 I arose to open for my beloved, And my hands dripped with myrrh, My fingers with liquid myrrh, On the handles of the lock.*

Our focus: Addressing LOVE'S hesitancies AND DISTRACTIONS

Previously

Song of Solomon 5:2-4 NKJV

2 I sleep, but my heart is awake; It is the voice of my beloved! He knocks, saying, "Open for me, my sister, my love, My dove, my perfect one; For my head is covered with dew, My locks with the drops of the night."

3 I have taken off my robe; How can I put it on again? I have washed my feet; How can I defile them?

4 My beloved put his hand By the latch of the door, And my heart yearned for him.

Today: Song of Solomon 5:5

"I arose to open for my beloved, And my hands dripped with myrrh, My fingers with liquid myrrh, On the handles of the lock". NKJV

This woman after having previously **hesitated** in responding to her lover because of her **procrastination** and **preoccupation** with self. She **finally arises to open** to her lover, her bridegroom.

- * **However, she is again wavers and hesitates to open to her beloved** because her attention is drawn towards her hands that are dripping with sweet smelling myrrh.
- * Momentarily she is **distracted** as she reflects on the beauty and attractiveness of her hands - because they were not always like that for previously as a village girl and she worked in the fields and vineyards her hands were cracked and nails broken and dirty etc.
- * **The hands dropping with myrrh** suggests to her the lingering memory of the encounter in which she underwent the preparation/beautification for marriage according to the Persian custom.

Example - Esther in the Bible (Chapter 2:12)

Before she (*Esther*) could appear before the King though, she had to go through an extensive purification and beautification process — "six months with oil of myrrh, and six months with perfumes and preparations for beautifying women." (Esther 2:12b) Can you imagine those salon treatments? The specific purification ritual described in the Book of Esther, where women were groomed and prepared for the king, appears to have been unique to the Persian court and the situation of Esther. While the Old Testament has accounts of women being presented to rulers and going through various forms of purification, the details of the ritual described in Esther seem to be specific to the Persian context and the selection of potential wives for King Ahasuerus.

Myrrh

Myrrh is good for skin. Myrrh oil can help to effectively reduce signs of ageing, wrinkles, and fine lines and can also help in wound care and skin conditions like acne, eczema, fungal infections, and inflammation.

It's beneficial for toning and moisturizing and can be used in lotions, cold compresses, and balms.

Application

- * It is possible that we also can sometimes be like this woman where momentarily the benefits and blessings of calvary can distract us from the task the mandate given to us.
- * This amazing salvation has wrought such a wonderful work in each one of us, and that should never be diminished or stopped being spoken of its transforming accomplishments in us.
- * BUT it should not occupy our attention to the extent that it delays or prevents us from actively carrying out the purpose for which we were saved.

WE ARE SAVED TO SERVE; THAT IS THE OTHER PART OF SALVATION.

MAINTAINING THE BALANCE

1. Between rejoicing in the benefits of salvation AND carrying out the purpose for which we have been saved.

In our plenty don't forget to fulfill

Deuteronomy 8:10-11

10 When you have eaten your fill, be sure to praise the Lord your God for the good land he has given you.

11 "But that is the time to be careful! Beware that in your plenty you do not forget the Lord your God and disobey his commands, regulations, and decrees that I am giving you today. NLT

Hebrews 13:15-16

15 Through Jesus, therefore, let us continually offer to God a sacrifice of praise — the fruit of lips that confess his name.

16 And do not forget to do good and to share with others, for with such sacrifices God is pleased. NIV - also **Deuteronomy 8:10-11** NKJV

Application

- * Have we ever been distracted or been overly occupied with things that relate more to ourselves ('self'), even though those things are good, and right?
- * **Things that we can legitimately claim to be "ours" as a result of the redemptive work of Jesus on the Cross (our salvation).**

Example

1. **Worship – our worship and the enjoyment and pleasure that we receive from worshipping him.**
- * For it is possible that our worship can be centered more around what benefits us, **the enjoyment and pleasure that we receive from worshipping him** BUT failing to balance it with the truth **that worship is exclusively for God and the pleasure that HE derives from being honoured and praised.**

MAINTAINING THE BALANCE – of these two things.

2. **That Worship is solely and exclusively for God – Luke 4:8**

For it is written in the Scriptures, 'Only One is worthy of adoration; therefore, worship only the Lord your God and love him supremely. The Passion Translation (TPT)

3. **And Our pleasure and enjoyment that we receive from worshipping God is only because of his pleasure at being honoured and we are just sharing in HIS satisfaction.**

MAINTAINING THE BALANCE

4. **Our communion with God** and its twofold purpose

- * Our ability to directly commune and fellowship with God is a wonderful privilege and blessing and brings us a sense of comfort and satisfaction.
- * But this access to God is more than the enjoyment of being able to speak to God; ITS purpose is also that God can now commune intimately with us, instructing, directing, correcting, disciplining and personally speak to us. It is designed that **dialogue** is to take place. (**Dialogue** - Conversation - Discourse – Interchange)
- * The joys and pleasures that we experience as a result of being saved are to be enjoyed BUT not in such a way that it reflects self and self-centeredness and fails to major on the promotion of God's side of things – his will – his pleasure, etc.

Amen - Ps Barry